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E.O. 12356: N/A
TAGS: PARM PROP UR
SUBJECT: OCTOBER 25 ARMS CONTROL PRESS CONFERENCE

SUMMARY

1. IN AN OCTOBER 25 PRESS CONFERENCE, DEPUTY FOREIGN MINISTER BESSMERTNYKH AND SOVIET NST NEGOTIATOR KARPOV CRITICIZED U.S. "DISTORTIONS" OF REYKJAVIK, USING ALLEGED QUOTES FROM THE PRESIDENT TO ARGUE THAT HE HAD AGREED TO ELIMINATE ALL STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE ARMS. KARPOV CLAIMED THAT THE SOVIET NST DELEGATION ALREADY HAD NEW INSTRUCTIONS, AND SAID THAT OMNIBUS NUCLEAR TEST BAN NEGOTIATIONS WOULD HAVE TO BE UNDERWAY BEFORE A START AGREEMENT COULD BE IMPLEMENTED. ON OTHER ISSUES, BESSMERTNYKH CRITICIZED THE BRITISH DECISION
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TO BREAK RELATIONS WITH SYRIA, AND INDICATED

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THE SOVIETS WOULD TAKE NO FURTHER ACTIONS AGAINST THE U.S. DIPLOMATIC PRESENCE IN THE USSR, ASSUMING NO FURTHER USSR STEPS. HIGHLIGHTS FOLLOW.

END SUMMARY.

ELIMINATION OF STRATEGIC ARMS

2. IN HIS OPENING STATEMENT, BESSMERTNYKH CHARGED U.S. SPOKESMEN WITH TRYING TO DISTORT WHAT HAD HAPPENED AT REYKJAVIK AND THE UNDERSTANDINGS REACHED THERE. IN PARTICULAR, BESSMERTNYKH CLAIMED THAT THE U.S. WAS ASSERTING THAT THE SIDES HAD AGREED TO ELIMINATE BALLISTIC MISSILES IN THE SECOND FIVE-YEAR PERIOD, WHEN THEY HAD IN FACT AGREED TO ELIMINATE ALL STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE ARMS, INCLUDING BOMBERS AND CRUISE MISSILES. THE PRESIDENT HAD PROPOSED BALLISTIC MISSILES, BUT HAD LATER AGREED TO GORBACHEV'S POSITION.

3. BESSMERTNYKH QUOTED THE PRESIDENT TWICE:

- -- IN THE COURSE OF THE REYKJAVIK
- TALKS, THE PRESIDENT HAD AGREED
- TO THE ELIMINATION OF ALL
- STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE ARMS: "IT
- LOOKS LIKE WE SIMPLY DID NOT UNDERSTAND

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- YOU, BUT IF THAT'S WHAT YOU WANT,
- FINE."

- -- THE PRESIDENT LED THE SOVIETS TO
- UNDERSTAND THAT HE WAS NOT OPPOSED
- TO ELIMINATING ALL NUCLEAR DEVICES,
- INCLUDING SDABSI, BATTLEFIELD : :
- WEAPONS, CRUISE MISSILES, INTER-
- MEDIATE-RANGE SYSTEMS AND SO
- FORTH: "IF WE AGREE THAT AT THE

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END OF TEN YEARS ALL NUCLEAR
ARMAMENTS WILL BE ELIMINATED, WE
CAN TRANSMIT THAT UNDERSTANDING
TO OUR DELEGATIONS IN GENEVA,
SO THAT THEY CAN PREPARE AN
AGREEMENT WHICH YOU (GORBACHEV)
CAN SIGN DURING YOUR VISIT TO
THE U.S."

4. ASKED ABOUT HIS REPORTED STATEMENT THAT SOME ABM TESTING COULD TAKE PLACE OUTSIDE THE LABORATORY, KARPOV REPLIED THAT THE ABM TREATY PERMITTED FIXED, LAND-BASED SYSTEMS TO BE DEVELOPED, TESTED AND DEPLOYED; BUT THIS WAS NOT SO FOR LAND-MOBILE, OR FOR SEA-, AIR- OR SPACE-BASED ABM SYSTEMS. HE ADDED THAT ABM SYSTEMS BASED ON NEW PHYSICAL PRINCIPLES COULD BE DEVELOPED AND TESTED, BUT ONLY IN CONJUNCTION WITH ARTICLE III OF THE TREATY WHICH SPECIFIED PERMITTED FIXED, LAND-BASED SYSTEMS.

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STRENGTHENING THE ABM TREATY REGIME

5. BESSMERTNYKH NOTED THAT STRENGTHENING THE ABM TREATY HAD BEEN AT THE CENTER OF THE DISCUSSIONS IN REYKJAVIK FROM THE VERY BEGINNING. HE CONTINUED THAT IT WAS NECESSARY TO STRENGTHEN THAT REGIME WHILE IMPLEMENTING RADICAL REDUCTIONS; THIS MEANT THAT THE SIDES WOULD NOT EXERCISE THEIR RIGHT OF WITHDRAWAL FOR TEN YEARS AND WOULD COMPLETELY OBSERVE THE TREATY'S PROVISIONS, AND THAT THEY WOULD NOT CONDUCT RESEARCH AND TESTING OF SPACE COMPONENTS OF AN ABM SYSTEM IN SPACE, WHICH THE TREATY DOES NOT ALLOW. BESSMERTNYKH LIMITED OFFICIAL USE LIMITED OFFICIAL USE

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SIDE-STEPPED A QUESTION REGARDING AN AP REPORT THAT THE SOVIETS HAD TOLD WASHINGTON AFTER

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REYKJAVIK THAT THEY HAD NOT MEANT A BAN
ON ALL SDI TESTING OUTSIDE THE LABORATORY.

GENEVA NEW SOVIET INSTRUCTIONS

6. KARPOV STATED THAT THE SOVIET DELEGATION
IN GENEVA ALREADY HAD NEW INSTRUCTIONS TO
REALIZE WHAT HAD BEEN AGREED IN ICELAND.

AGAIN, IT'S A PACKAGE

7. ASKED ABOUT THE POSSIBILITY OF A SEPARATE
INF AGREEMENT, KARPOV SAID THAT THE RADICAL
NATURE OF SOVIET PROPOSALS DEMANDED THAT
THEY BE TAKEN AS A PACKAGE.

TEST BAN TALKS - PART OF THE PACKAGE

8. KARPOV ASSERTED THAT OMNIBUS NEGOTIATIONS
TO BAN NUCLEAR TESTS HAD TO BE "UNDERWAY"
BEFORE AN AGREEMENT ON STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE
ARMS REDUCTIONS COULD BE IMPLEMENTED.
HE CONTINUED THAT THE SOVIETS WERE READY
TO INCLUDE DISCUSSION OF LIMITS ON
NUMBER OF TESTS, YIELDS, AND THE TTBT AND
PNET, BUT THE MAIN OBJECTIVE OF THE
NEGOTIATIONS SHOULD BE TO HALT TESTING.

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BRITISH BREAK OFF RELATIONS WITH SYRIA

9. BESSMERTNYKH CRITIZED THE BRITISH
DECISION TO BREAK OFF DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS
WITH SYRIA, WHICH WAS NOT A HELPFUL STEP
AND WITHOUT FOUNDATION. IT COULD EVEN
BE CHARACTERIZED AS "PROVOCATIONAL."

U.S.-SOVIET EXPULSIONS

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10. IN RESPONSE TO A QUESTION, BESSMERTNYKH ASSERTED THAT THE U.S. HAD BEGUN THE RECENT WAVE OF EXPULSIONS (WITH ITS "GROUNDLESS" REDUCTION OF SOVIET U.N. PERSONNEL). HE NOTED THAT THE STATE DEPARTMENT HAD ANNOUNCED THAT THE U.S. WOULD TAKE NO FURTHER STEPS; THE SOVIET SIDE HAD TAKEN ITS RETALIATORY MEASURES WHICH WERE SUFFICIENT. EACH SIDE'S DIPLOMATIC ESTABLISHMENTS SHOULD WORK UNDER EQUIVALENT CONDITIONS.

COMMENT

11. BESSMERTNYKH'S AND KARPOV'S COMMENTS
GENERALLY REPEATED PREVIOUS SOVIET POSITIONS,
ALTHOUGH THE NEW TWIST WAS BESSMERTNYKH'S
QUOTING OF THE PRESIDENT TO REFUTE
ALLEGED U.S. MISREPRESENTATIONS OF
REYKJAVIK. HAVING BROKEN THE ICE, THE
SOVIETS MAY IN THE FUTURE MAKE FURTHER
SELECTIVE RELEASES OF THEIR NOTES OF THE
LEADERS' DISCUSSIONS.

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